

2A - WHAT IS AI AND HOW DO I OPEN IT?

approx 4-5 minutes · Read this into HeyGen. Do not add stage directions.

Welcome back, Digital Pioneer.

You finished Lesson 1. You made your screen easier to read. You showed up for Lesson 2. Most people who sign up never get past the first lesson. You came back. That matters.

Today is the lesson that changes things. You are going to have a real conversation with artificial intelligence. Not watch a video about it. Not hear someone talk about how amazing it is. You are going to open it, ask something, and get a real answer back. Today.

And I want you to hear this first. You are not late. Most people your age have never used a tool like this. About three out of four adults 65 and older have never used a chatbot. You are not behind. You are right on time.

I have taught this to adults in their 50s, 60s, 70s, and 80s. All of them were nervous. All of them did it anyway. And almost every one of them said the same thing afterward. They said, that was it? That was what I was afraid of?

So let us talk about what AI actually is.

When most people hear those words, they picture a robot, or a movie about machines taking over. That is what movies have shown us for 50 years.

Here is the reality. You may already use a little AI every day. If you have asked Siri or Alexa a question, if Google Maps has told you where to turn, if Netflix has suggested a show, that is a small piece of the same idea. What we are opening today is like that. Except this one can hold a real conversation.

AI, the kind we are going to use, is a conversation partner. You type something. It types back. You ask a question, it answers. You say you do not understand, it explains it differently. That is the whole thing.

Think about Google for a moment. Google hands you a stack of websites. You click. You scroll. You try again. A lot of people get tired of that. This tool sits down and talks it through with you. Then you can ask a follow-up, the same way you would with a good teacher.

It does not judge you. It does not get impatient. You can ask the same thing three times.

Now I want to be honest. It is not perfect. Sometimes it sounds very sure about something that turns out to be wrong. You stay in charge. Use it to learn and explore. Double-check anything medical, legal, or financial with a real professional. And do not type your Social Security number, bank numbers, or passwords into it. We will go deeper on safety in Lesson 3.

Okay. Let us open it up.

The tool we are using is called ChatGPT. It is made by a company called OpenAI. The first session is free. You do not need an account to try it.

Open your browser. On iPhone that is Safari. On Android it is usually Chrome. On a computer it might be Chrome, Edge, or Firefox. All of them work.

Find the address bar at the very top. Tap it or click it.

Type this. chatgpt.com. C-H-A-T-G-P-T dot com. Press Enter.

You should land on a clean page. Near the bottom you will see a box where you can type a message. That is the whole interface.

If a pop-up asks you to log in or sign up, look for Stay logged out, or Continue without an account. You can create a free account later if you want to save your chats. You do not need one right now.

If typing feels hard, look for a little microphone near that box. You can speak your question instead.

You are in. I will see you in Lesson 2b, where you are going to ask your very first question.

2B - ASK YOUR FIRST REAL QUESTION

approx 4-5 minutes · Read this into HeyGen. Do not add stage directions.

Welcome back.

You have ChatGPT open. That message box is waiting. Now we are going to use it.

I am going to give you a starter question. Change the details so they are true for you.

Type this.

I am over 50 and new to AI. I want to use it for something practical in my life. Explain the most useful thing I can do with it today, in five short steps, in plain language.

Go ahead and add your real age if you want. Add one true thing about your life. A letter you need to write. A trip. A recipe. A job task. AI gives better answers when you give it a little context.

Press Enter or tap the arrow. Then watch.

Text is going to start appearing, word by word. It is writing a response for you, right now, for this conversation.

Read the whole answer. Take your time. Read it the way you would read a letter from a knowledgeable friend.

Notice what just happened. No hold music. No waiting room. No feeling like you were bothering someone. An answer, in plain English, in about ten seconds.

Here is the rule that makes the answers better. The more specific you are, the better the response.

If you ask, how do I use AI, you will get a general answer. If you ask, I am 68 and I want help writing a letter to my insurance company about a billing dispute, keep it polite but firm, you will get something you can actually use.

Same idea if you are still working. If you say, help me rewrite this email so it sounds clear and confident, it will do that. If you paste a confusing paragraph from an HOA letter or a Medicare statement, ask it to say that in plain English. Do not paste account numbers. A sentence or two of the confusing part is enough.

Think of it like giving directions to a taxi driver. The more landmarks you give, the closer they get you.

So try another question that is real to your life. Ask it to explain a word. Ask it for a recipe using what is in your refrigerator. Ask it to help you write a birthday message. Ask it to explain a news story in three sentences. Ask it to help you practice a conversation you are nervous about.

There is no wrong question. There is no question too simple. There is no such thing as wasting its time.

You are doing something most people your age have never done. You are using one of the most powerful tools in the world, right now, for something that matters to you.

That is what Digital Pioneers do.

In Lesson 2c, I am going to show you the one technique that takes you from beginner to confident user. It is called the follow-up. And it changes everything.

approx 4-5 minutes · Read this into HeyGen. Do not add stage directions.

Welcome back.

You asked your first question. You got your first answer. That is already more than most people ever do.

Now the single most important technique. The follow-up.

Most beginners read the first answer and close the tab. The first answer is just the beginning. The real value lives in what happens next.

Think about a great conversation with a good doctor, a good teacher, a good advisor. You did not ask one question and leave. You said, wait, say more about that. You said, I did not understand that part. You said, can you give me an example.

AI works the same way. Except it never looks at the clock.

After you read the first response, try one of these.

Can you explain that in simpler terms?

Can you give me a real example of how someone my age would use this?

What should I do first?

I did not understand the part about, and then name the part that confused you.

Can you make that shorter?

What should I check with a real person before I use this?

Notice you do not need to start over. In this conversation, it remembers what you already said. You can just keep going.

Here is what I want you to try right now. Go back to the answer you got. Find one thing you want to know more about. Ask a follow-up. Read that answer. Ask another if you want.

This is how real learning works. Not from one explanation. From a conversation.

Let me leave you with a few things people your age actually use this for.

You can ask it to explain a Medicare statement or an insurance letter in plain language. You can ask it to help you write a birthday message for a grandchild. You can ask it to plan a road trip. You can ask it to suggest books based on ones you already like. You can ask it to help you practice a conversation you are nervous about. You can ask it to summarize a long article in three sentences.

It is extra help. It is not a replacement for your doctor, your family, or a real friend. You stay in charge.

It is available at two in the morning when you cannot sleep and you have a question and there is no one to call.

I want to tell you a story. A woman came to one of our workshops at a library in Austin. She was 72. She had been telling herself for five years that she was too old for this. She sat down. She typed her first question. Three minutes later she looked up and said, I just asked it to explain a letter from my insurance company, and it said in plain English what my paperwork never did.

That is what this is about. Not technology for its own sake. Technology that actually serves you.

You are not behind. You have not missed your window. You are a Digital Pioneer, and today you proved it.

Lesson 3 is next. We are going to talk about staying safe online. How to spot a scam before it costs you. How to protect your information. How to use technology with confidence instead of fear.

But right now, stay in ChatGPT a little longer. Ask it something that matters to you. Something you have been curious about for a while.

You earned it.

I will see you in Lesson 3.